Number Steps record

Check one child, one-to-one, for 10 to 15 minutes. Start a step or two below where you expect difficulty. Stop at the first step where the child keeps making mistakes.

PUPIL INITIALS	YEAR GROUP	DATE CHECKED	CHECKED BY	REVIEW DUE (6 WEEKS)

Secure: confident, correct, without help **Emerging:** some of it, or only with help **Not yet:** couldn't do it yet

STEP	QUICK CHECK (FULL WORDS IN THE TOOL)	RESULT	WHAT DID YOU SEE? HOW DID THE CHILD GET THE ANSWER?
STEPS 1 TO 5 · THE MEANING OF NUMBER			
1 **Comparing and matching**	3 spread wide vs 8 close together: which has more? Put towers of 1 to 5 cubes in order.	☐ Secure ☐ Emerging ☐ Not yet	
2 **Saying the counting words**	Count as far as you can. Start at 4. What comes after 6? Count back from 10.	☐ Secure ☐ Emerging ☐ Not yet	
3 **Seeing small numbers at a glance**	Flash 1 to 5 dots for two seconds: how many? Counts, or just knows?	☐ Secure ☐ Emerging ☐ Not yet	
4 **Counting a set**	Count 7 cubes in a row, then scattered, then from the other end.	☐ Secure ☐ Emerging ☐ Not yet	
5 **Knowing how many**	Cover after counting: how many? From 15 cubes, give me 3, 5, 7. Spread one row of 6.	☐ Secure ☐ Emerging ☐ Not yet	
STEPS 6 TO 9 · SMALL NUMBERS WORKING TOGETHER			
6 **Linking numerals, words and amounts**	Read cards 0 to 10. Order them and find the missing one. Give me this many.	☐ Secure ☐ Emerging ☐ Not yet	
7 **Comparing numbers on a line**	Which is bigger, 5 or 8? Put 7, 2 and 5 on a 0 to 10 line.	☐ Secure ☐ Emerging ☐ Not yet	
8 **Numbers inside numbers**	5 cubes, some under a cup: how many hiding? Ten-frame with 7. Show 5 another way.	☐ Secure ☐ Emerging ☐ Not yet	
9 **Early adding and taking away**	4 sweets and 3 more. 5 under a cloth and 3: counts on? 4 + 4, so 4 + 5?	☐ Secure ☐ Emerging ☐ Not yet	
STEPS 10 TO 15 · BIGGER NUMBERS AND PROBLEMS			
10 **Ten as a group, and numbers to 20**	Full ten-frame and 4: how many? Make 16. Write fourteen, then forty.	☐ Secure ☐ Emerging ☐ Not yet	
11 **Number facts to 20**	6 + 6, so 6 + 7? 8 + 5, how? Ten mixed facts: knows or works out?	☐ Secure ☐ Emerging ☐ Not yet	
12 **Word problems**	4 red and 3 blue. Had some, ate 2, have 4. Ella 7, Sam 4: how many more? 7 – 3?	☐ Secure ☐ Emerging ☐ Not yet	
13 **Counting in tens, and numbers to 100**	Count on from 27 to 43. Tens from 6. Fives from 0: what comes after 35?	☐ Secure ☐ Emerging ☐ Not yet	
14 **Tens and ones, and adding to 100**	What does the 4 in 43 mean? 50, 20, 85 on a 0 to 100 line. 10 more than 36. 23 + 14.	☐ Secure ☐ Emerging ☐ Not yet	
15 **Early multiplying and sharing**	3 plates of 2. Share 12 between 3. 12 in groups of 3. Double 4, half of 10.	☐ Secure ☐ Emerging ☐ Not yet	

Write down how the child got each answer. A child who counts from 1 to get it right is at a different point from a child who just knows.

Teaching plan and reviews

Pupil initials: _____ Start date: _____

Teaching starts at step

Step number

The first step marked emerging or not yet. Keep earlier steps going in short warm-ups.

Activities I'll use

Each session: 10 to 20 minutes, every day if you can

Counting	Number ideas	Calculating	A story problem
2 to 3 min	5 to 7 min	5 to 7 min	5 to 7 min

- Use the same numbers all session.
- Objects, then pictures, then written numbers.
- My turn, together, your turn.
- Ask ‘How did you work it out?’
- Get it right first. Speed comes last.
- Keep the routine the same each time.

Reviews

Repeat the same tasks with the same numbers at about six weeks and at the end of each block.

DATE	STEP NOW	DECISION	NOTES

Secure: move to the next step. **Some progress:** carry on at the same step for another block. **Little or no progress:** check the child is at the right step, and change the approach. **Little or no progress after two blocks:** talk to your link EP.

Talk to your link EP if

- [ ] Two blocks of teaching at the right step, with little progress
- [ ] Not secure at steps 4 and 5 by the end of Year 1
- [ ] An uneven profile, with gaps scattered across many steps
- [ ] Other needs, such as language, attention or memory, make it hard to tell what's getting in the way
- [ ] Anxious about maths, or avoids number work

Bring this sheet to the consultation. It shows your EP where to start.